

Rep. Tom Emmer on Fine Point with Chanel Rion

OAN

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CHANEL:

discuss a senior member of House Republican leadership, Minnesota Congressman and Majority Whip Congressman Tom Emmer. Congressman, thank you for joining us and thank you more importantly for putting this report together. What specific steps could leadership in Minnesota have taken once they got wind of this level of fraud?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well good to be with you Chanel. Go back, you started your report which is fantastic by the way and I appreciate every time that people bring this to light for the general public. You started out by saying Tim Walz, our governor, and our Attorney General Keith Ellison knew about this fraud in specific, the feeding our future scandal, the 250 million dollar feeding our future, the children's meals program. They knew about it as early as 2019. It's not just a long time, this is years that this went on and you asked me what should happen when he says we will find you, we will prosecute you, and we will throw you into jail. He should be looking in a mirror because this guy is likely the one that was giving the signals that we're not gonna get sued. You know he was committing, he and Ellison I understand, were actually going after, they were having retribution against whistleblowers. Look his chief of staff, longtime chief of staff, is one of the almost 10-12 people that were deposed by Jamie Comer's Oversight Committee and he would not give a straight answer. So we have to wonder, we're left to wonder, what did Tim Walz actually know when he knew about it in 2019? I'll leave you with this Chanel, you don't let a billion dollars or more, in this case 18 billion dollars, go out of your state government without somebody being aware. By the way let's go back there another person you don't have in this report is Ilhan Omar. Remember Amy Bach was just sentenced to 41 years for her involvement in feeding our future and she said Ilhan Omar was at the center but she knew about it. Some of these people have to be held accountable and they should be going to jail.

CHANEL:

Well what happens after this report comes out? I mean what's the next step tangibly?

REP. TOM EMMER:

It's been referred to the vice president. As you know, President Trump is the one who has made this a central theme of his administration, rooting out fraud so that these dollars that are intended for the disabled, for the elderly, for mothers, single mothers with children, so that these dollars actually go to the people that they were intended for instead of for instance Somali fraudsters and corrupt politicians in my state. So where it goes from here, Jamie Comer and the Oversight Committee have issued their report. They have written a letter to Vice President J.D. Vance who President Trump has appointed to oversee this pursuit of fraud from Minnesota to California back to New York and all points in between and that's where it'll go. I'm sure the Department of Justice is looking into it. The FBI has been looking into it. It's time though that some public officials who were charged with the responsibility of oversight of these programs be held accountable and when you listen to Tim

Walz tell you that they were looking for fraud, the one thing you know for sure is if Tim Walz is talking he's telling another lie.

CHANEL:

So you know regardless of who ends up paying for this from a justice orientation standpoint, the question becomes you know we go back to the motivations. Was it financial? Was it political? Were there payouts involved to other actors at play? Was it fear? What do you, having gone over this, believe was the driving motivation for the top-level officials to just turn the other way with this much money involved?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well I would say is it possible that it's all of the above? Let's start with the political. Back in 2017 then Democrat Attorney General Lori Swanson was investigating and prosecuting Somali daycare fraud. Lori Swanson ran for the Democrat nomination for governor of the state of Minnesota in 2018. She happened to lose to a guy named Tim Walz. That same year Keith Ellison ran to replace Lori as the Attorney General of Minnesota. When the two of them were elected the first thing Keith Ellison did was in the office of Attorney General he created a rule that there would be no more investigations without his express approval and there never were. Why is that important from a political standpoint? Well depending on who you talk to there's 100 to 125,000 Somali diaspora in Minnesota. Keith Ellison gets elected by less than a point reelected and Tim Walz gets elected by with 52%. Those votes are incredibly important to tilting because you also have to look at this fact. There's 87 counties in Minnesota. You realize that when Tim Walz was reelected in the last election with 52% of the vote he only won 13 of the 87 counties. In the 74 counties in Minnesota he lost he got 37% of the vote. This includes his former congressional district. So this is incredibly important. Then just fast forward to 2020. There's a tape with the Somali fraudsters from Feeding Our Future. They don't trust Keith Ellison. They're taping him while he's making promises that he is going to help them avoid scrutiny and guess what within a week or two he's getting campaign donations from the same people. So I don't know. Is it possible that it's all of these? I know this. This thing stinks to high heaven. It's a high time that a public official charged with watching over precious funds from generous taxpaying Americans should be held accountable.

CHANEL:

Absolutely. Well Congressman thank you for putting this out and we'll be tracking this. I want to ask you just before you go because I know that you're one of the you're one of the leading members of Congress when it comes to cryptocurrency. You serve on the chair of the Congressional Crypto Caucus and I really wanted to ask what your take has been on the volatility we've seen recently in the markets over the last few weeks regarding crypto, Bitcoin, lots of debate happening on the Hill. Don't want to get too much in the weeds but what's your initial response to what what do you think is happening right now?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well first off you're always gonna have markets that make adjustments and changes but this one Chanel I think is directly related to the fact that we have not passed the Clarity Act yet that was passed out of the house more than a year ago. We passed something called the Genius Act. It was signed into law. That is a stable coin legislation that makes stable coins a reality. Dollar back stable coins. But in order for that to work in this country you need a market structure bill. You need to know if you're an entrepreneur, you're an investor, you need to know who, which regulator you're working with. Are you a security? If so you work with the SEC. Are you a cash? If so you work with the Treasury. Are you a commodity? If so you work for the CF, you work with the CFTC. We need that clarity bill because that is the other side of the coin when it comes to digital assets and I'm confident we're gonna get it done here before the end of the year.

CHANEL:

All right Congressman Emmer, thank you very much for the time. We appreciate it as always.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you Chanel.

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